

2.1.2 WordPress (www.wordpress.org)

WordPress is a open source blog publishing system that can also be used to host blogs. It is free to use and is very suitable for someone who wants to host blogs in his/her domain. In case you don't have a domain, you can sign up for your very own Wordpress blog.



Sign up for WordPress

After reading our review of Blogger, you might be tempted the rather obvious question—"what makes this different"? or rather, "why should I use it"? The answer to these questions is control. Blogger is Google property, and just think what would happen if your Google account gets hacked? You would be shut out of everything: mail, calendar, reader. And if you have a blog with a flourishing readership, that goes too! Even though such a catastrophe does not occur, there is always the chance that you will not find enough configuration options or tweakability to make your blog stand out from the crowd. These are some of the reasons for using Wordpress. Another great reason is that with just the click of a mouse, you can import and export blogs from Wordpress. Did we mention plug-ins?

Wordpress blogs are the ultimate in tweaking. With enough time on your hands and by being a tech-savvy, you can make your blog look as good as a professionally designed site. Wordpress blogs have plugins—downloadable widgets that can be used to extend the usability and features of a barebones blog. Get the full list of plug ins from <http://www.wordpress.org/extend/plugins>. Some of the most popular downloadable ones are those that manage activities such as commenting, posting and statistics. Most of these plug-ins are free and developed by third-party developers.

Signing up is free and fast—select a name for your blog, username and password and you are all set to blog.

After signing up, choose your template and widgets that would add more zing to your blog. Wordpress comes with about